



UCI 203

Desktop Publishing Technologies

For

Computing and Information Technology

[DTP Handbook]

©Nov., 2025 Compilation for only UCI 203



DESKTOP PUBLISHING (DTP)

Topics and Learning Organization:

- 4.1 Introduction
 - 4.2 Definition of desktop publishing
 - 4.3 Purpose of desktop publishing
 - 4.4 Types of desktop publishing software
 - 4.5 Designing a publication
 - 4.6 Manipulating text using the toolbox
 - 4.7 Editing a publication
 - 4.8 Formatting a publication
 - 4.9 Printing a publication
-

4.1 Introduction

In your position you must have asked yourself how newspaper and book publishing companies manage to produce publication that are attractive with creative layouts and graphics in large volumes. They do this through a special process called *publishing*.

- Publishing is the process of producing publications like newspapers, business cards, pamphlets, fliers, pictures, calendars etc. that have special text, graphic layout and design.
- Traditional method of publishing involved drawing and writing manually on wooden or metallic boards. The artwork would then be painted with ink and pressed on papers to produce a printout. ***This was very tedious!***
- Today, the art of publishing has changed because of the advent of personal computers and smaller printers that are able to print high quality text and graphics, in an office or at home.

4.2 Desktop Publishing (DTP)

Desktop publishing refers to the process of producing publications like cards, newspapers etc., by designing their text and graphic layout and inserting, editing, formatting and printing of text and graphical objects using a special desktop publishing software installed on a computer.

- The term *Desktop* means that all the publishing processes can now be done on a desk in the office or at home using a personal computer.
- The difference between a desktop publisher and a word processor is that a desktop publisher software gives the user more tool and control of the page layout, text manipulation and graphic design than a word processor.



- However, it is important to note that some word processors today have also been incorporated with text and graphic formatting and editing tools. Hence a thin line exists between them and the desktop publishers. For example, you can now design a full publication in Microsoft Word by using the available drawing and picture tools and create columns etc.
- Example of DTP software include: *Adobe PageMaker, Microsoft Publisher, Corel Draw, Adobe Photoshop, Adobe InDesign, Corel Ventura, Harvard Graphics etc.*

4.3 Purpose of Desktop Publishing Software

Desktop Publishing programs are very popular in publishing because they give the person designing the publications a lot of control on:

Graphic design: Using a desktop publishing software, a typesetter can create and edit very complex text and graphical objects like pictures to the finest details, e.g. the software provides the user with rulers and ruler guides that can be used to place an object in exactly the correct position.

Page layout design: With a desktop publisher, the user can be able to design a page layout by setting consistent picture and object locations, dividing a page in a number of columns and creating *layers*. A layer can be viewed as the arrangement of objects on top of each other with the one on top being on the first layer e.g., text can be on one layer while graphical objects on another. This will allow the text layer be manipulated separately from graphical object layer, e.g., text moves separate from the objects. You can also make the graphical object layer transparent in order to make the text in a layer behind the object visible.

Printing: The main purpose of any desktop publisher is to produce publications, this cannot be accomplished without printing. Desktop publishing software therefore helps the user prepare what is referred to as artwork in commercial circles for printing.

Term and Expressions in DTP

- **Graphic design** in DTP, also known as *communication design*, is applied always in a day-to-day activities of human while communicating ideas or transmitting information.
- It is the art and practice of planning and projecting ideas and experiences with visual and textual content.



- The process normally takes physical or virtual and includes handling images, words, or graphics or the combination of both.
- **Page layout** is the part of graphic **design** that deals with the arrangement of visual elements on a **page**.
- It began from the early illuminated pages in hand-copied books of the “Middle Ages” and proceeded down to the modern **magazine** and catalog **layouts**.
- Proper **page design** has long been a consideration in printed material.

Principles of Art and Design in DTP

- In any discipline or professional career, there must be principles, rules, guidelines to be followed or adhered to in order to succeed.
- Some of these principles or rules exist for ethical reasons.

There 7 principles that define the Art when designing for DTP reasons:

Balance: - refers to the visual weight of the elements of the composition.

It is a sense implying that the painting feels stable and "feels right." Imbalance causes a feeling of discomfort in the viewer.

Balance can be achieved in 3 different ways:

- (a) **Symmetry**, in which both sides of a composition have the same elements in the same position, as in a mirror-image, or the two sides of a face.
 - (b) **Asymmetry**, in which the composition is balanced due to the contrast of any of the elements of art. For example, a large circle on one side of a composition might be balanced by a small square on the other side
 - (c) **Radial symmetry**, in which elements are equally spaced around a central point, as in the spokes coming out of the hub of a bicycle tire.
- (i) **Contrast:** this is the difference between elements of art in a composition, such that each element is made stronger in relation to the other.

When placed next to each other, contrasting elements command the viewer's attention. Areas of contrast are among the first places that a viewer's eye is drawn.



Contrast can be achieved by juxtapositions of any of the elements. Negative/Positive space is an example of contrast. Complementary colors placed side by side is an example of contrast.

- (ii) **Emphasis** is when the artist creates an area of the composition that is visually dominant and commands the viewer's attention. This is often achieved by contrast.
- (iii) **Movement** is the result of using the elements of art such that they move the viewer's eye around and within the image. A sense of movement can be created by diagonal or curvy lines, either real or implied, by edges, by the illusion of space, by repetition, by energetic mark-making.
- (iv) **Pattern**: - this is the uniform repetition of any of the elements of art or any combination thereof. Anything can be turned into a pattern through repetition. Some classic patterns are spirals, grids, weaves.
- (v) **Rhythm** is created by movement implied through the repetition of elements of art in a non-uniform but organized way. It is related to rhythm in music. Unlike pattern, which demands consistency, rhythm relies on variety.
- (vi) **Unity/Variety** – form of painting that presents a unified feeling, such that all the elements fit together comfortably in a given placing or location.
 - Too much unity creates monotony, too much variety creates chaos. You need both. Ideally, you want areas of interest in your composition along with places for your eye to rest.
 - Currently, *Adobe PageMaker*, **CorelDraw** and **InDesign** are the most commonly used commercial DTP software. But beginners in DTP and students find it easier to use Microsoft-Publisher, since it inherits most the features of Microsoft Word

Advantages of DTPs over word processors

Though some of the work done using DTP software can also be accomplished on modern word processors, DTP software have superior feature that make them outshine word processors. Some of the advantages of DTP software over word processor include:

1. Every item on a page is contained in a frame and can be edited and formatted independently.



2. Stories can be contained in a single frame or threaded between several frames.
3. Frames need not flow in logical sequence. For example a story on page 1 may be continued on page 8.
4. Master pages are used to set a common layout which may be repeated on several pages, e.g. logo, page numbers etc.
5. Publications can be printed in a form suitable for commercial printing e.g., using colour separations.
6. Wide range of templates is available, e.g. brochures, booklets, posters, business cards, etc.
7. Multiple stories from different authors can be handled with ease.

4.4 Types of desktop publishing software

Generally, desktop publishing software can be classified into two broad categories namely graphic-based and layout-based DTPs.

Graphic-based: They are specifically developed to edit and format graphic objects such as pictures and vector drawings. Vector drawings are freehand drawings such as those those drawn by fine artists. Examples of graphic-based DTP software include Adobe Photoshop, Adobe Illustrator and CorelDraw. These software have superior image handling capabilities like setting resolution, brightness, contrast, cropping and filling images with all types of colour. It is important to note that some graphic-based software like CorelDraw and Illustrator are also used for page layout design.

Layout-based: These types of desktop publishers are specifically developed to create different page layout designs for text and pictures. Have you ever wondered how the complicated front page of a newspaper is developed? It is difficult to achieve such without a good layout based DTP. Good examples of layout-based DTP softwares include Adobe PageMaker, Microsoft Publisher and InDesign.

4.5 Designing a publication

Publications vary in design and formatting. For example, a card has a design that is different from a newspaper. It is possible to produce different types of such publications using a desktop publishing software. Examples of publications designed using DTPs include:

Cards: These may be for weddings and other special occasions like graduations and congratulations.



Certificates: To show completion of courses and special events. These type of publications are very sensitive because they must be designed to discourage any type of duplication or counterfeits.

Newspapers, magazines, pamphlets and newsletters: Have news targeting many people. They may have much text, graphic layouts and designs.

Books: Are bulky publications with many pages bound together within the same publication.

Calendars: Apart from showing dates, they are used by companies to advertise their products, hence most of them have heavy catchy graphics.

Getting started with Adobe PageMaker

Currently *Adobe PageMaker*, *CorelDraw* and *InDesign* are the most commonly used commercial DTP software. However beginners in DTP and students find it easier to use *Microsoft Publisher* since it inherits most of the features of *Microsoft Word*. Though in this chapter we explore how to create a publication using *PageMaker*, we have provided an appendix that demonstrates how to achieve the same using *Microsoft Publisher*, a package in *Microsoft Office Suite*.

Commercially, since *Adobe InDesign* is gradually replacing *PageMaker*, you may be expected to bridge the latter gap. However, for now let's start off with *PageMaker 7.0*.

Launching Adobe PageMaker

1. Click the **Start** button and then point to **Programs**.
2. On the programs sidekick menu, point to **Adobe group**, then select **PageMaker**.
3. The *PageMaker* program starts and provides the *Document Setup* dialog box. If the Document setup dialog box is not displayed, then click **File** menu and select the **New** command.
4. In the *Document Setup* dialog box specify the publication setup options.
5. Click **OK** to apply the selected options. A publication window similar to the one in Figure 4.1 is now displayed.

PageMaker screen layout

The *PageMaker* application window looks like most application windows for programs you have used before. It also has a title bar, menu bar and



scroll bars. However, you will note that unlike most of the Microsoft applications you have used before, Adobe PageMaker does not have a status bar on its application window. The most notable difference between a desktop publishing software such as PageMaker and a wordprocessing software such as Microsoft Word is that a desktop publishing software has its printable work area centred on a *pasteboard*.

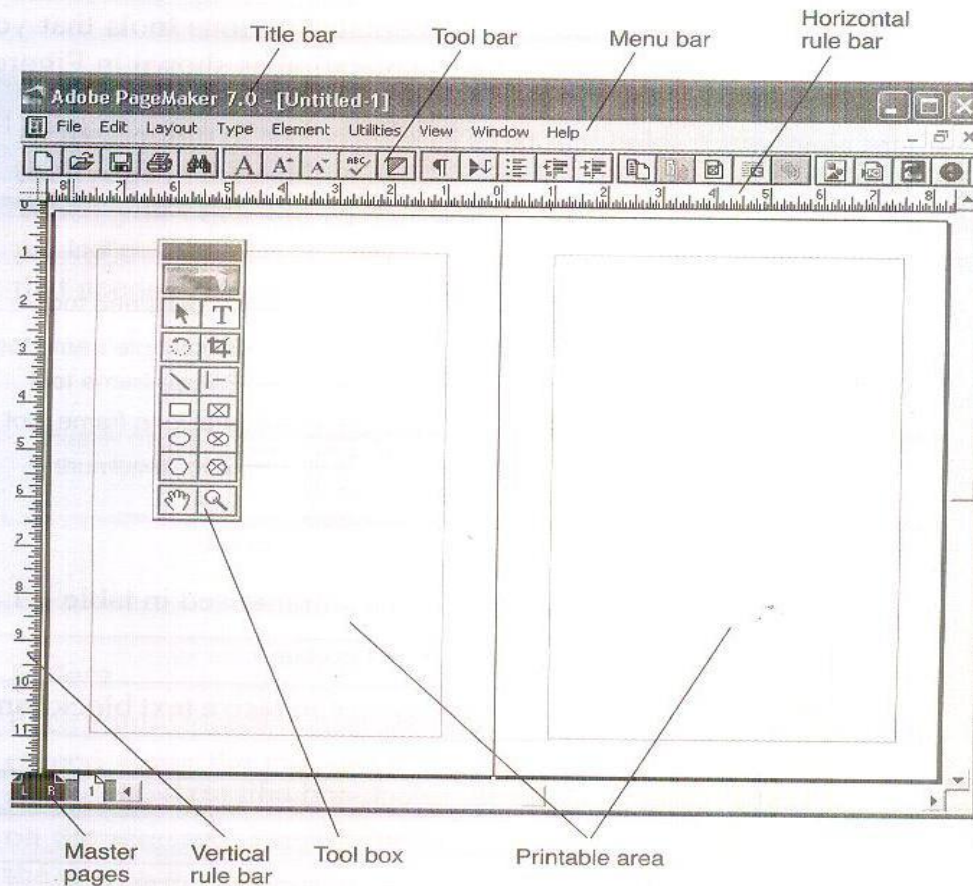


Fig. 4.1: Adobe PageMaker window.

The PageMaker publication window has the following features:

1. The pasteboard.
2. The printable area.
3. The toolbox.
4. Master pages.
5. Rulers.
6. Control palette.

The pasteboard

A pasteboard is a large blank area where you place text and graphical objects before arranging them neatly on the printable work area enclosed with margins.

**The printable area**

It is the area that looks like a page surrounded by margins on the pasteboard. Any object or text that is placed on the printable area will be printed by the printer.

The Toolbox.

This is a set of buttons that contains various tools that you can use to create and manipulate your publication as shown in Figure 4.2.

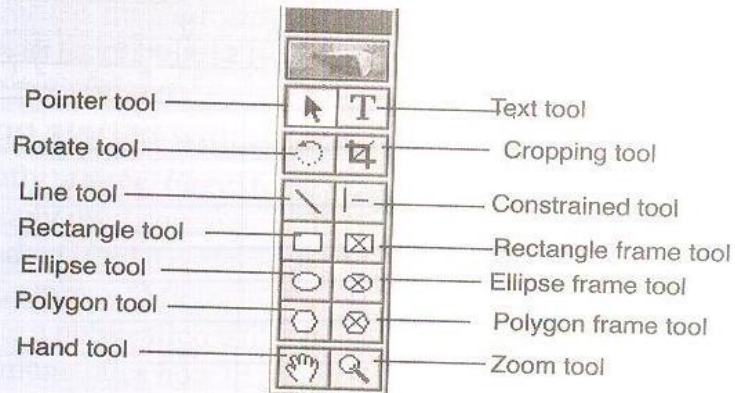


Fig. 4.2: Toolbox

The function of each tool can be summarised in table 1.1 as follows:

<i>Tool</i>	<i>Purpose</i>
Pointer	Select, move, and resize text blocks and graphical objects.
Text	Type, select, and edit text.
Rotate	Select and rotate objects.
Crop	Crop i.e. trim imported graphics.
Line	Draw straight lines in any direction.
Constrained line	Draw vertical or horizontal lines.
Rectangle	Draw squares and rectangles.
Rectangle frame	Create a rectangular <i>placeholder</i> for text and graphics.
Ellipse	Draw ellipses and circles.
Ellipse frame	Create a circular or oval placeholder for text and objects.
Polygon	Draw basic polygons such as triangle, pentagons, stars etc.



<i>Tool</i>	<i>Purpose</i>
Polygon frame	Create a polygonal placeholder for text and graphics.
Hand	Scroll the page or to preview and test <i>hyperlinks</i> .
Zoom	Magnify or reduce an area of the page.

Table 4.1

Master pages icons

At the bottom of the window is a bar that holds thumbnails representing each page in the publication. To move to a page, just click its thumbnail. When you click the master page thumbnail (Figure 4.3), the master page(s) are displayed. A master page is used to design a general layout that needs to be applied in all other pages of a publication.

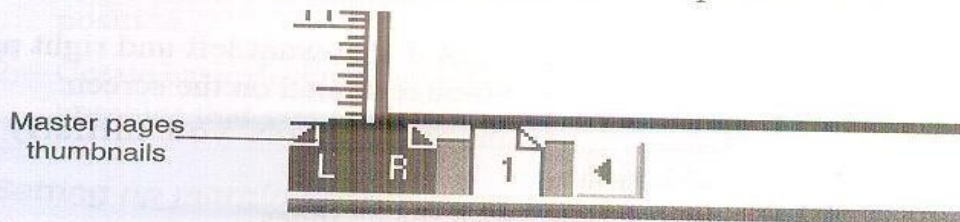


Fig. 4.3: Master pages

Rulers

Each publication window can include horizontal and vertical rulers. They extend along the top and left borders of the window. You can display rulers when you need them and hide them when you want more room on the screen to view a publication. The rulers must be visible to help the user to manually create *ruler guides*. Ruler guides are non printable lines or guides that ensures that text and raphical objects are in the required place.

Control pallete

It is a shortcut toolbar mainly having text and paragraph formatting command icons. In case you launch PageMaker and the pallete is not displayed, On the Window menu, click Show Control pallete.

Setting up a publication

Sometimes, it is necessary to change the setup options of a publication e.g. page size, margins, orientation etc.



To change publication's setup:

1. From File menu, click Document Setup. A dialog box such as the one shown in Figure 4.4 appears.
2. Select the following page set up options:
 - (a) In the Page size list box, select the appropriate size. When you select a Page size, its dimensions appear in the Dimensions text boxes. Alternatively select *custom size* then use the dimensions text box to specify a custom Page size of up to 1065 by 1065 mm.
 - (b) Select page orientation by either clicking Tall for portrait or Wide for landscape orientation.
 - (c) Click Double-sided to set inside and outside margins to accommodate binding on pages that will be printed on two sides.
 - (d) Click Facing pages if you want left and right pages displayed together as a two-page spread on the screen.
 - (e) Enter the number of pages you initially plan for the publication.
 - (d) Click OK to effect the changes.

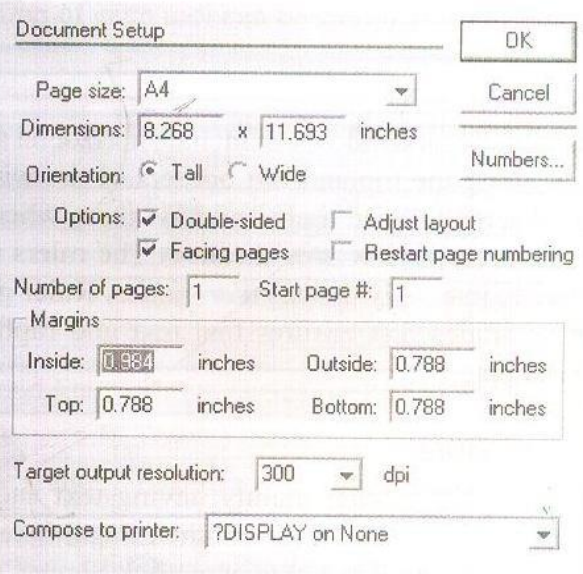


Fig. 4.4: Document setup dialog box

Setting up a publication using master pages

If you are creating a publication that will have several pages such as a book or a project report, it is important that you lay out a common layout



foundation for all pages for the sake of consistency and cohesiveness. These pages used to design a common layout to be applied in the other pages of the publication are called *master pages* or a *document master*. You can create, modify, and delete objects on master pages just like any other objects, but you must do so from the master pages themselves.

The document master applies to all pages in the publication until you specify otherwise, and cannot be renamed or removed from the publication. To switch to master pages, simply click the master page icon(s) then:

1. Place non-printing ruler guides on the master pages to help you place text and graphics accurately and consistently throughout your publication. Non-printing ruler guides are vertical or horizontal lines you place on the printable area. You place the guides by positioning the mouse pointer on the ruler, then dragging the guide to the required position.
2. Create basic design elements on the master pages, including text and graphics that you want to appear on each page in your publication.

Setting up margin guides

Margin guides are very important because they define the printable area publication.

To change margin settings:

1. On **File** menu, click **Document Setup**.
2. In the Setup dialog:
 - (a) Enter the values for Inside and Outside margins for a double sided document to accommodate binding for a document that will be printed on both sides. For single sided pages, set the left and right margins; and
 - (b) Enter the value for the Top and Bottom margins.
3. Click **OK** to close the setup dialog box and effect the changes.

Saving the layout

Once you complete setting up your publication layout, it is important to save it before you start entering text and graphics.

To save the layout:

1. To save the publication for the first time, from the **File** menu, click **Save As** or click the **Save** button on the toolbar.



2. In the *Save As* dialog box, specify the name of the file and the storage location of your publication then click Save button.
3. To save changes made to a publication, from the File menu, click **Save**.

Displaying and hiding rulers

If the rulers are not displayed, click the View menu, then Show rulers to display them. To hide the rulers, click the View menu, then Hide rulers.

Selecting ruler measurement units

It is possible to set different measurements on both rulers. For example, you can set the vertical ruler in millimetres and the horizontal in inches. Therefore if you want to use common units, you must set each ruler measurement independently.

To set the measurement units:

1. Right click a ruler separately. A drop down list displays available measurement systems; that is *inches*, *decimal*, *millimeters*, *picas* and *Ciceros*. If you are not familiar with some of this units, it is advisable you use millimetres.
2. Select the measurement system option you want to use:

Review questions 4.1

1. What is desktop publishing?
2. Why is a desktop publisher preferred in designing documents than a word processor.
3. Give three examples of desktop publishing software available in the market today.
4. You have been requested as the patron of journalism club to design for them a 5 page school magazine. The magazine layout should display the school logo at the top of every page. Explain how you would achieve this.
5. What are Master pages?
6. What is layering as used in DTP? Why is it a very useful feature in a desktop publisher.
7. Differentiate between the *Pasteboard* and *printable page*.



8. Explain the importance of each tool on PageMaker's toolbox.
9. What commands are used in place of portrait and landscape page orientation in PageMaker?
10. What are the three main purposes of a desktop publishing software?

4.6 Manipulating text and graphical objects

Manipulating text

Using text tool

To create a text block with the text tool:

1. Click the **text tool** from the toolbox. The pointer turns into an I-beam.
2. On an empty area of the page or pasteboard click or drag a rectangular area to define a text block or frame. If you click without dragging, a text block the width of the column or page will be created. It is the text frame that defines the space you want the text to occupy. The borders of a text block remain invisible until you click the text with the pointer tool.
3. Type the text you want.

Using text frame

You can create text by using a frame tool or by converting any object you have created with the drawing tools except a line into a frame. Text frames do not change height or width as you add or remove text.

To add text into a frame orientation in PageMaker:

What are the three main purposes of a desktop publishing software?

- (a) Click the text tool, click in the frame, and then type or paste text from the clipboard
- (b) On the **File** menu click **Place**, double-click the file that contains the text you want to place in the text frame. When the cursor becomes a loaded icon, click inside the text frame to place the text.

You can also add text into a text frame by:

1. Selecting a text block, hold down **Shift**, and then select an empty frame.



2. From the **Element** menu, point to **Frame** and click **Attach Content**. The text flows into the frame and the text block disappears.

Manipulating graphical objects

The toolbox has several graphic drawing tools. For example, the polygon tool helps a person to draw polygons and the ellipse tool is used for drawing circular objects. All these tools enable a person to apply *stroke* and *fill* patterns. For more complex graphics, PageMaker allows a person to import pictures from other applications and to *place* them in the publication. A stroke refers to a line style, while a fill refers to applying patterns such as shading. Figures 4.5(a) and 4.5(b) shows examples of fill and stroke respectively applied to simple rectangular graphical objects drawn using the polygon tool.

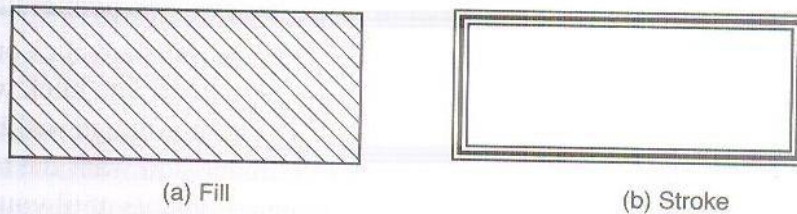


Fig. 4.5: A fill and a stroke

Applying stroke and fill

Once you create a graphical object, you can enhance it by applying stroke and fill. To apply stroke or fill:

1. Select the object you want to apply Stroke or Fill.
2. On the **Elements** menu, either point to **Stroke** to apply a line style or **Fill** to fill the object with a background colour or pattern. Alternatively, click the **Fill and Stroke** command on the toolbar to set the fill and stroke options in the dialog box.

Moving and resizing text and graphical objects

Once you create text and graphical objects, you can adjust the size, shape, or location of an object.

To move a text or graphical object:

1. Click the object to select it, then position the pointer tool anywhere inside the text or object.



2. Drag the text or object to a new position.

To resize a text or object:

1. Select the text or object with the pointer tool. Selection handles are displayed at the corners of the text block or the object.
2. Position the pointer on the selection handle and drag to the required size.
3. Apply fill pattern and stroke.

4.7 Editing a publication

The term edit means making changes to a publication. In most cases, editing would include the process of correcting spelling mistakes, replacing words etc.

You can search for specific occurrences of a word or group of words in your publication and make the necessary changes. PageMaker comes with two special editing tools namely the *Find and Change* tool and the *Spelling tool*.

Before editing the publication, you must open it in the *story window*. PageMaker defines each text block as a story. Once text is in PageMaker, it is part of a story. A story is a text block that PageMaker recognizes as a single unit. A story can be one letter or several hundred pages of text, and can be contained in a single text object or threaded through many different ones.

Find and change

Find and change helps a person to search for a particular word or a phrase and replace it with another one. To find and change a word and or a phrase in the publication:

1. Using the text tool, click an insertion point in a story, or select a range of text if you want to limit your search to that section.
2. Click **Edit** menu, then select **Edit story** command. The publication now opens in the story window showing only the text but not the graphical objects.
3. Click **Utilities**, then **Find** or **Change**. A dialog box such as the one shown in Figure 4.6 is displayed.
4. In the Find What text box, type or paste the text you want to find. To change the text, type new text in the Change To text box. To search for formatting only, leave the text boxes blank.



- 5 Select Match Case and Whole Word as appropriate.
- 7 In the dialog box, specify the formatting to search for and, if appropriate, how you want to change it and click OK.
8. Select options to determine the scope of the search e.g. in *all open publications* or only the current one. If you search the current publication only, select Search Story option.
9. Click Find to begin the search.
10. Click Find Next to continue with the search operation.
11. Once you are through, click Story menu then close Story. Alternatively press Ctrl +W.

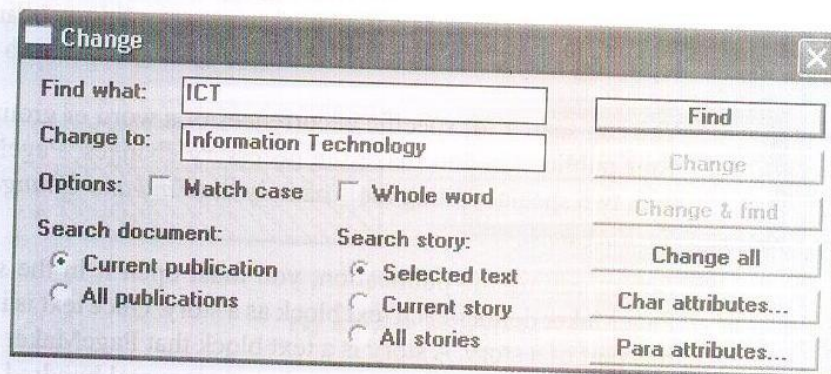


Fig. 4.6: Find and change

Checking for spelling mistakes

To check spelling in one or more publications:

1. Click the insertion pointer anywhere in the publication or select the range to be spell checked.
2. On the Story Editor menu, choose Utilities, then Spelling. A dialog box appears.
3. Specify the scope of the search either as:
 - (a) In selected text;
 - (b) In the current story only; and
 - (c) In all stories in the publication.
4. Specify spell checking options:
 - (a) Checking Alternate Spellings lets you see suggested replacements for misspelled words; and
 - (b) Checked Show Duplicates displays/repeated words.
5. Click the Start button and spell checking begins.



4.8 Formatting a publication

This refers to applying special attributes to text, graphical objects and pages in order to make them attractive and appealing to the eye. Therefore, formatting may include things like font sizing, bolding, changing text colour, adjusting picture brightness and contrast and formatting columns on the page.

Text and paragraph formatting

To format your publication, you can either use commands available in the *Type* menu or a control palette. The Control palette is a strip that contains command buttons and list boxes that let you assign attributes to text and graphical objects.

To display the control palette

From **Window** menu, click **Show Control Palette**. The *Control palette* appears floating on top of your publication (Figure 4.7). You can move it by dragging the bar at the left edge of the palette.

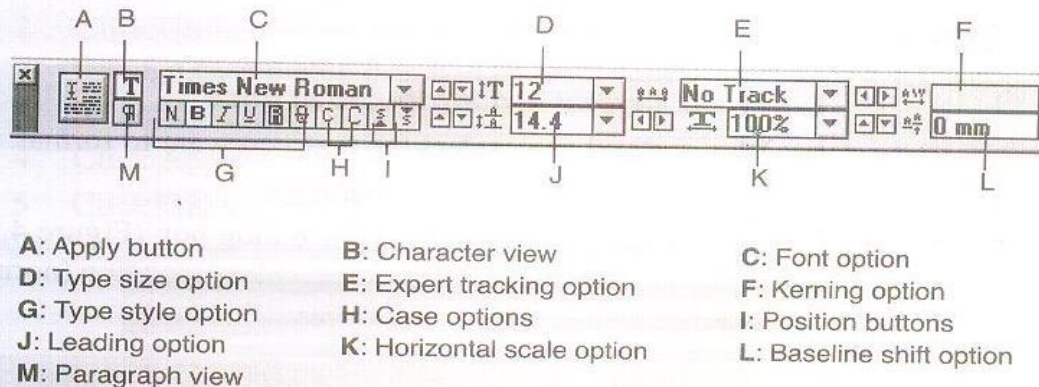


Fig. 4.7: Control palette in character view

The contents of the Control palette vary depending on which tool is selected from the toolbar or from itself. The two types of control palettes are the object mode and text mode. The text mode can be selected by clicking the **Character view** or **paragraph view** button. There are two types of text modes namely:

1. The *character view* that is, when the T tool on the palette is selected. This means that you can apply character attributes to selected text. Character attributes determine how text looks on the page such as font type, size, or style (bold, italic or regular).



- The paragraph view that is, when you select a paragraph and you click the button below the T on the control palette (labelled M) in Figure 4.7., the palette in paragraph view (Figure 4.8) is displayed. You can apply paragraph styles, select alignment options, and other paragraph attributes.

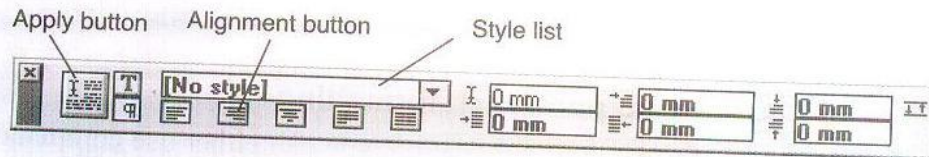


Fig. 4.8: Control palette in paragraph view

In object view when a graphical object is selected, it lets you apply attributes related to the object such as rotating, moving, resizing etc.

To format text:

- Using the text tool, select the text you want to format.
- On the **Type** menu or the Control palette, choose the formatting attribute you want.

To format several text attributes at once

- With the text tool, select the text you want to format.
- On the **Type** menu, click **Character**.
- In the *Character Specifications* dialog box (Figure 4.9), select text attributes such as font, size, type, colour, position (normal, subscript, superscript etc.) then click **OK**.

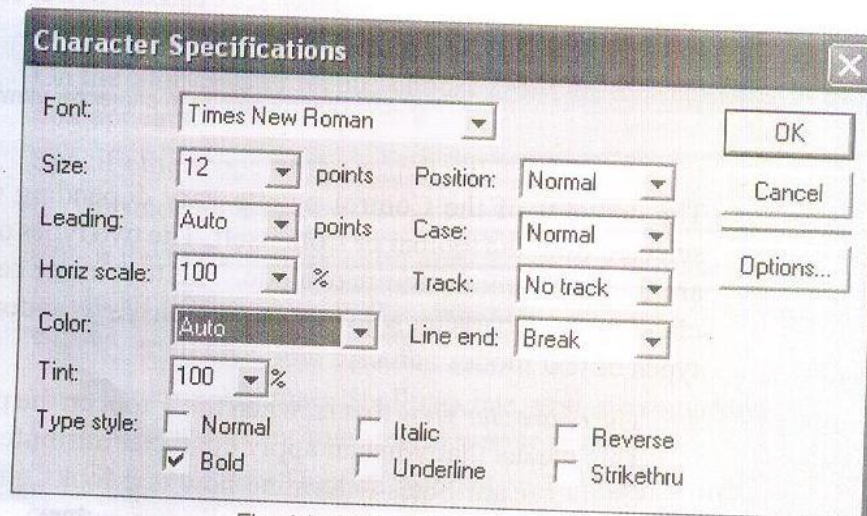


Fig. 4.9: Character formatting dialog box



1. Font list box and style buttons.
2. Font size and leading list box.
3. Tracking and Horizontal scale.

Changing text colour

1. Select the text.
2. On **Window** menu, choose **Show Colors**.
3. In the colors dialog box, click the **Colors** tab.
4. Select the colour you wish and it will apply on the selected text.

Changing case

As with Microsoft Word®, you can also change text case to lower case, upper case, Title case, sentence case and TOGGLE CASE.

To change case:

- 1 Select the text you want to change case.
- 2 Click **Utilities** menu, point to **Plug-ins**, and then click **Change case**. Change case dialog box will be displayed as in Figure 4.10.
- 3 Select the case you want.
- 4 Click **Apply** to preview the change.
- 5 Click **OK** to close the dialog box.

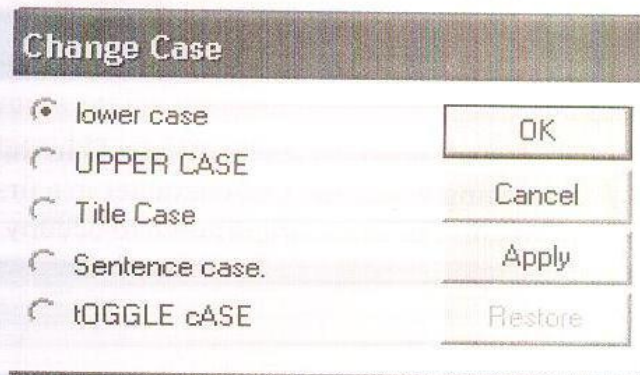


Fig. 4.10: Change dialog box

Formatting text to superscript and subscript

Superscript refers to text that is positioned slightly higher than the rest on the same line e.g. the power of 3 in 10^3 while subscript refers to text slightly below the same line such as 2 in H_2O . To format text to superscript or subscript:



1. Select the text you want to style as superscript or subscript.
2. On **Type** menu, click **Character** and the dialog box in Figure 4.11 appears.
3. In the Character dialog box, select either superscript or subscript from Position list box as shown, then click **OK**.

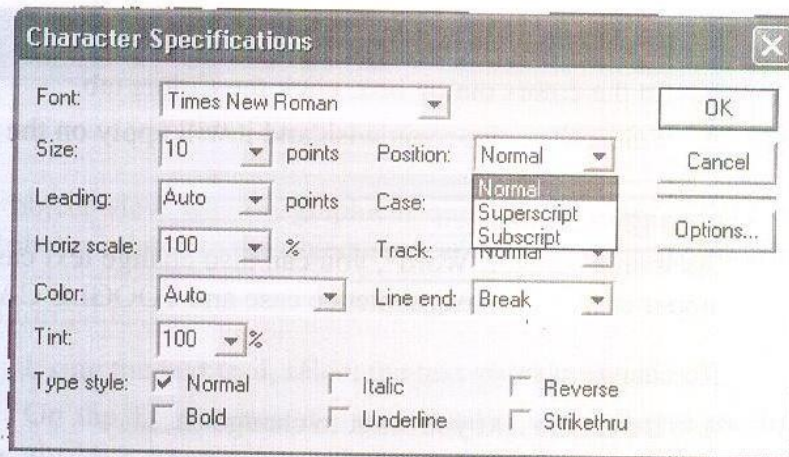


Fig. 4.11: Setting superscript and subscript

To remove superscript or subscript format:

1. Repeat step 1 and 2 above.
2. In the character dialog box, select **Normal** from Position list box, and then click **OK**.

Drop cap

Drop cap as shown by the first letter D in this paragraph refers to formatting where the first character in a first line of a paragraph is bigger. The letter drops down to occupy the space in the next lines.

To apply drop cap:

1. Select the character you want to drop.
2. Click **Utilities** menu, point to **Plug-ins**, and then click **Drop cap**.
3. Specify the number of lines you want the character to occupy in the Size box as shown in Figure 4.12.
4. Click **Apply** to preview the format and then **OK** to close the dialog box.

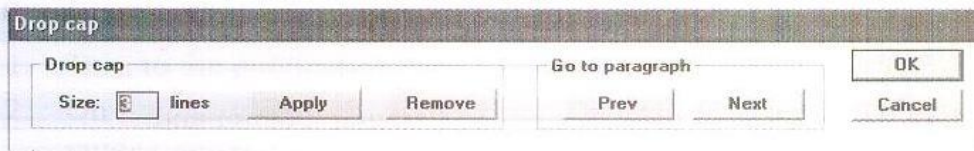


Fig. 4.12: Drop cap dialog box

Paragraph formatting

You can use either *Control palette* to format a paragraph or Paragraph command from the Type menu. However the latter lets you apply formatting that is not available on the Control palette.

Setting indents and tabs

Indents and tabs are powerful tools for positioning text. Indents move text inward from the right and left edges of a margin while tabs position text at specific positions. You can set indents by moving the indent markers in the *Indents/Tabs ruler*, typing indent values in the *Paragraph* dialog box or type indent values on the *Control palette* in paragraph view.

To set tabs using the *Indents/Tabs* ruler:

1. Select the paragraph or paragraphs you want to indent.
2. On **Type** menu, click **Indents/Tabs**.
3. On the *Tab ruler*, click a tab-alignment icon (left, right, center, or decimal) for the first tab you want to set. See Figure 4.13.
4. Drag the new tab marker along the ruler.
5. If you want the tab leader, click the **Leader** button then choose the type of leader you want.

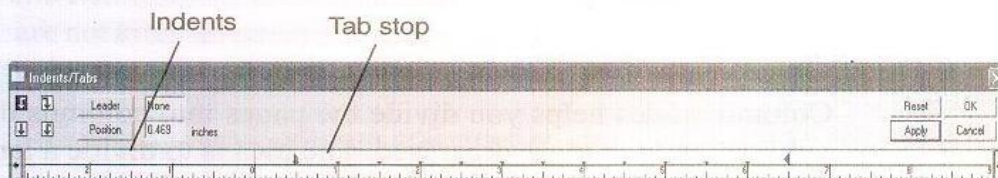


Fig. 4.13: Tabs/ indents on ruler

To set indent using the *Control palette*:

1. Select a paragraph or paragraphs you want to indent.
2. On the Control palette, click the paragraph-view button.



3. Type values for the indents in the Indent text box then press the Enter key.

To set an indent using the Paragraph command:

1. Click an insertion point in a paragraph, or select a group of paragraphs.
2. On Type menu, select Paragraph.
3. Type values for the Indents options, and then click OK.

Adding space above or below paragraphs

You can control the vertical space between paragraphs by specifying the amount of space before or after selected paragraphs or all paragraphs of a certain style.

NB: *PageMaker* never inserts space before a paragraph set to begin at the top of a column or page (using the Page Break Before or Column Break Before attribute). For those cases, you must add the extra space manually by typing one or more paragraph returns.

To increase or decrease space before or after a paragraph:

1. Select the paragraph you want to edit.
2. Choose Type, then Paragraph.
3. In the Paragraph Space options, specify the values you want in the Before and After text boxes.

Page formatting

This refers to formatting the whole page and may include things like column guides.

Column guides

Column guides helps you divide the pages into columns that make the publication look more organised. The idea is to divide a large page into short readable sentence sections. Imagine if a newspaper page was not divided into columns! Therefore, columns are mostly used in designing large publications, newspapers and journals. The difference between column guides and margin guides is that margin guides are around the edges of the printable page while column guides may split the page at the centre. *PageMaker* marks margins with a blue line but column guides with pink coloured lines.



To set up more columns:

1. Turn to the publication page or master page.
2. On **Layout** menu, choose **Column Guides**. You can set up column guides separately in a double sided facing pages document by clicking **Set left and right pages separately** check box as shown in Figure 4.14.
3. Enter the number of columns you want on the page and the space you want between columns. If you are setting left and right pages separately, enter values for both pages.
4. Select **Adjust Layout** if you want existing text and objects on the page to adjust to the revised column setup.
5. Click **OK**.

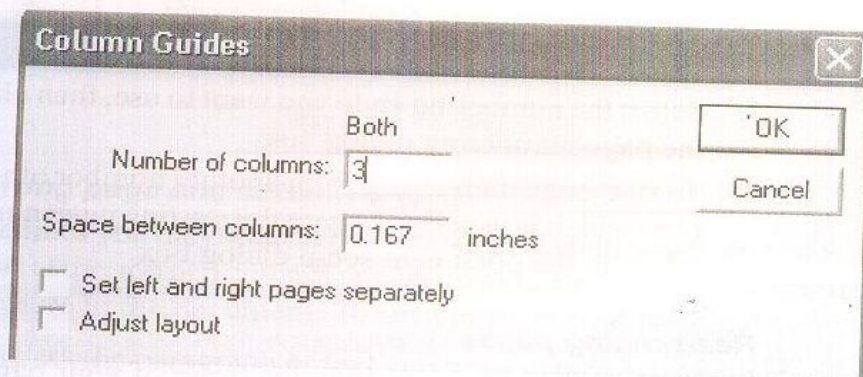


Fig. 4.14: Setting column guides.

Moving and locking columns

You can move the column guides by dragging them. The two lines forming the *gutter* between columns move in pairs and the space between the two lines remains consistent. Text and graphics already on the page are not affected when you drag column guides. Once you have set up your columns, you can lock them in place to prevent accidental moving.

To lock or unlock column and ruler guides:

From **View** menu, click **Lock Guides**.

Page numbering

To print page numbers in a publication, you must set the page numbers in the master pages. You do this by adding a *page-number marker* (a special character) that keeps track of the page order in the publication and ensures that each page is numbered correctly at all times.



To add page-number markers to master pages:

1. Click the master page(s) icon
2. Click where you want the page number to be placed.
3. Press **Ctrl + Alt + P**. Page-number markers appear as RM (right master) or LM (left master) on the master pages but actual page numbers are displayed on each page of your document.

Changing page number style

By default, PageMaker applies the Arabic page numbering style i.e. 1,2,3,.....

To change the style:

1. On **File** menu, click **Document Setup**.
2. In the Page setup dialog box, click **Numbers**.
3. Select the numbering style you want to use, then click **OK** to close the page numbering dialog box.
4. To start page numbering from another number other than the default one (which is usually 1), type the starting page number in **Start Page #** box in the document setup dialog box.

Rearranging pages

In PageMaker, you can change the order of your pages by rearranging page *thumbnails* (icons at the bottom of the window that represent pages). Changing the order of pages does not affect the text objects in your publication, even though they may have moved to different pages.

Sorting pages

1. On **Layout** menu, click **Sort Pages**. Figure 4.15 shows *Pages sorter* dialog box.
2. Select the page or pages you want to move either a single-sided page or a pair of facing pages. To select one page in a pair of facing pages, press **Ctrl** and click the page.
3. Drag the selection to the location you want. To insert a selection between a pair of facing pages, press the **Ctrl** key and drag the selection over the facing pages. Notice that a black bar indicates where the selected pages will be inserted.
4. Release the mouse button to drop the page onto the new position. PageMaker automatically rennumbers the pages. The original page



icon appears dimmed and another page icon appears beside the thumbnail to indicate its new page number.

5. Click **OK** to change the page order.

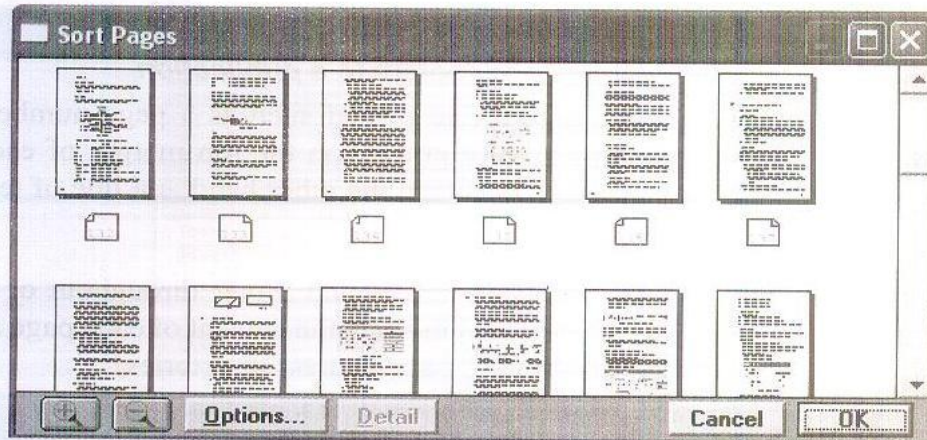


Fig. 4.15: Sorting pages

Inserting page and column breaks

Sometimes you may want certain text or paragraphs such as a new chapter to start at the top of a column or page regardless of editing or reformatting elsewhere in the document. To set a page or column break:

1. Select the paragraph or text you want to move to another column or page.
2. On **Type** menu, select **Paragraph**. Paragraph specifications dialog box (Figure 4.16) is displayed.

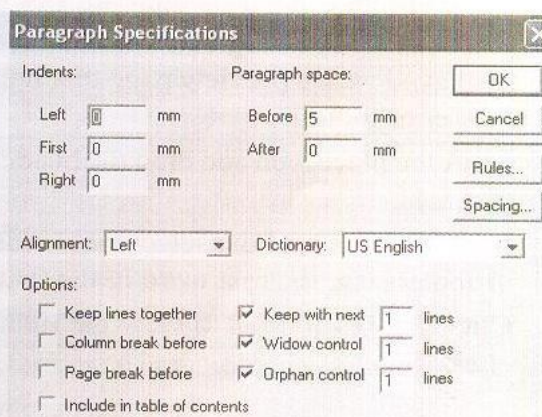


Fig. 4.16: Paragraph dialog box



3. Check *Column Break Before* to force the paragraph to start at the top of the next available column or *Page Break Before* as shown in Figure 4.16 to force the paragraph to start at the top of the next available page.

Adding headers and footers to a publication

A *header* refers to a line of text such as a page number, date, or a company name usually printed on the top margin of each page in a large document. A *footer* on the other hand is a line of text printed in the bottom margin.

You can use the same header and footer throughout or use *running headers* and *footers* that indicate the content of each page as is the case in dictionaries, telephone and address directories.

Defining consistent headers and footers

To define header or footer common throughout the publication:

1. Click the master page(s) icon.
2. At the top of the page, click where you want header to appear or at the bottom click where you want the footer/header to be placed.
3. Type the text that you want displayed on every page in your publication.

Defining Running headers and footers

- 1 Select the text block you want to use to create running headers and footers using the pointer tool.
- 2 Click **Utilities**, point to **Plug-ins** and then select **Running Headers and Footers**. A dialog box such as the one shown in Figure 4.17 is displayed with a preview page that helps you correctly position the header or footer.
- 3 Click the place icon and drag the header/footer place holder onto the text page.
- 4 In the content list box, select the words that will be used as headers or footers e.g. the first word in the first paragraph, then click **Add**.
5. Click **Preview** button to view the running headers/footers and then click **OK**.

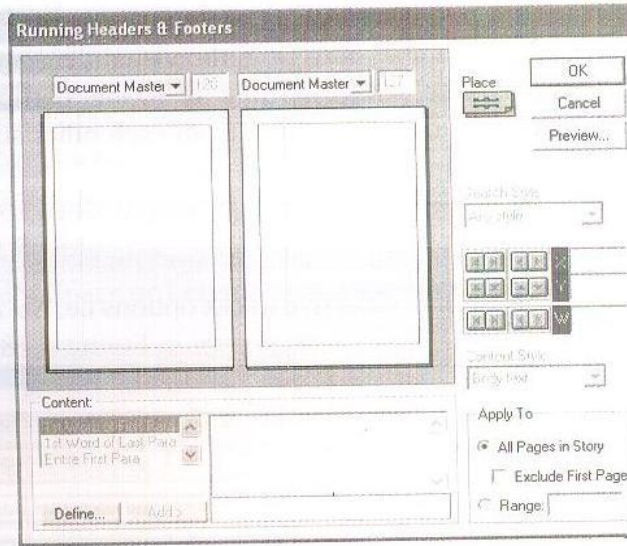


Fig. 4.17: Running headers and footers

Review questions 4.2

1. What are non-printing guides?
2. Give three nonprinting guides used in PageMaker.
3. Explain how you would create different columns on the same page.
4. What does the term gutter mean in relation to column setting?
5. Differentiate between margin guides and column guides.
6. Explain how you would lock column guides to avoid accidental moving from the current position.

Practical activity 4.1

Complete the school magazine so that it will be a multiple page document with the following sections:

1. School History
2. Administrative structure
3. What is offered in every academic department.
4. School performance in national examinations for the last two years.
5. Games and clubs.
6. Jokes and entertainment.



Tracking and Kerning

Tracking refers to changing the visual denseness or openness of characters in a line, while kerning is fixing particular pairs of letters that are too close or too far apart from each other such as To, Ta, We, we, Wo etc. To apply a track:

1. Select the text you want to track.
2. On **Type** menu, choose **Expert Tracking**.
3. Choose one of the five tracks options i.e. *No Track*, *Very loose*, *Loose*, *Tight* or *Very Tight* as shown in Figure 4.18.

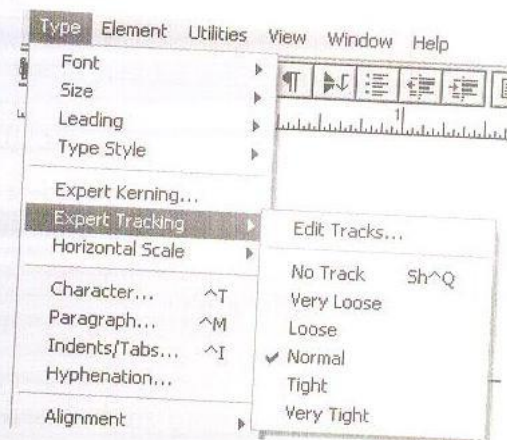


Fig. 4.18: Tracking text

To automatically kern a pair of characters:

1. Select the text you want to kern.
2. On **Type** menu, click **Expert Kerning**.
3. In the dialog box such as the one shown in Figure 4.19, click the appropriate slider button to make the text either tighter or looser.
4. Click **OK** to apply expert kerning.

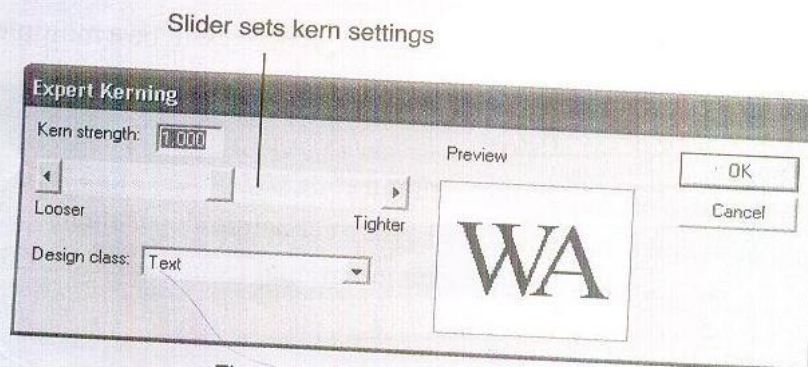


Fig. 4.19: Expert kerning dialog box



Line spacing

To adjust space between lines in paragraphs:

1. Select one or more paragraphs.
2. On **Type** menu, click **Paragraph**.
3. In the Paragraph dialog box (Figure 4.20),
4. Click **Spacing** to display Spacing dialog box.
5. In Word Space or Letter Space, type new values, and then click **OK**.

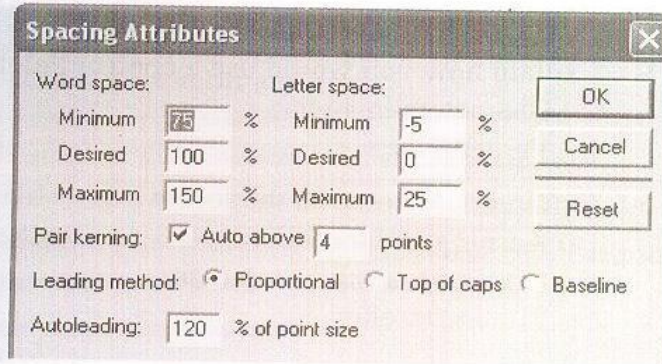


Fig. 4.20: Spacing dialog box

Setting ruler measurements

In PageMaker, you can design page layouts and graphics that are exact in measurement as specified using the horizontal and vertical rulers. The idea is to drag ruler guides to mark an area of the screen where you want to insert graphics or text that can fit in the guides. For example, to draw a rectangle of 5 cm by 5 cm:

1. Set the rulers to measure in millimetres by right clicking anywhere on the ruler, and then select *Millimeters*.
2. Drag ruler guides from the horizontal and vertical rulers to create a 5 x 5 cm space. Finally, select the rectangle tool and drag a rectangle that fits exactly inside the marked region as shown in Figure 4.21.

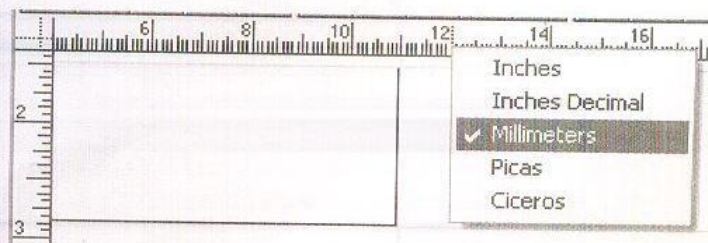


Fig. 4.21: Setting ruler measurements



Review question 4.3

1. Explain how you would create text using
 - (a) Text tool;
 - (b) Text frame.
2. Explain how you would draw a hexagon.
3. What is a text frame? How would you convert a rectangular shape into a text frame so that you can place text in it.
4. What is a Control Palette?
5. Explain how you would use a control Palette to format:
 - (a) Characters in a text;
 - (b) Paragraphs.
6. Differentiate between the following:
 - (a) Kerning and tracking;
 - (b) Change case and drop cap;
 - (c) Fill and stroke.

Practical activity 4.2

1. Draw the following basic shapes:
 - (a) 5 cm by 7 cm rectangle;
 - (b) A circle with 6 cm radius;
 - (c) A hexagon.
2. Draw a circular text frame and fill it with the following text:

"Computer Studies is relatively a new area of study, which is very dynamic. Due to this reason, every one of us is expected to keep abreast with changing trends in Information Communication and Technology (ICT)".
3. Format the character in bold into superscript or subscript:
 - (a) H₂O
 - (b) CM₂
 - (c) NH₄OH
 - (d) 1 x 10³
 - (e) Fe₃O



Formatting graphical objects

Using the PageMaker tools and formatting effects, you can create very complex graphical objects.

Changing fill and stroke of graphics

To change fill or stroke of an object:

1. Select the object by clicking it.
2. On **Element** menu, click **Fill and Stroke**.
3. Select the type of fill or stroke you want.
4. Select colors for the fill and stroke.

To apply fill:

1. Select the object.
2. On **Element** menu, point to **Fill**, then select the fill pattern you want to apply.

To apply stroke:

1. Select the object.
2. On **Element** menu, point to **Stroke**, then select the line style you want to apply.

Applying rounded corners

To apply rounded corners to rectangles and squares:

1. Select the rectangle or square whose corners you want to change.
2. On **Element** menu, choose **Rounded Corners**. A dialog box such as the one shown in Figure 4.22 is displayed.
3. Select the corner style you want, then click **OK**.

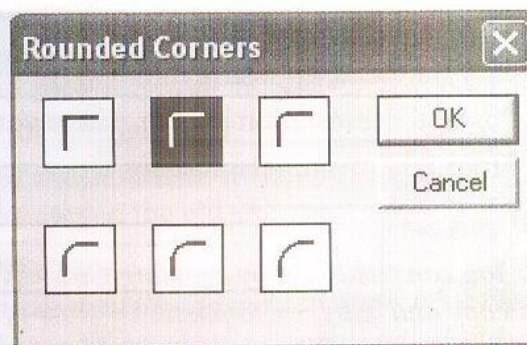


Fig. 4.22: Setting rounded corners



Creating complex polygons

Once you draw a polygon, you can change it from the default rectangle or square to *triangles*, *pentagons*, *hexagons* and even a *star*.

To set the number of sides or create a star object:

1. Select a polygon you want to reshape.
2. On **Element** menu click **Polygon Settings**.
3. In the Polygon settings dialog box, specify the number of sides you want, from three to a hundred.
4. To create a star, enter a value in the Star inset box. A value of zero percent means no star while 100 percent represents a star whose vertices meet at the centre. Figure 4.23 shows a star with ten vertices and 66 percent inset.
5. Click **OK**.

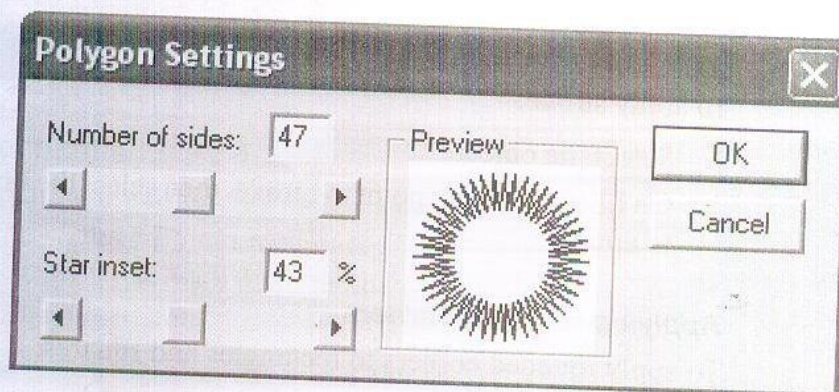


Fig. 4.23: Polygon settings dialog box

Copying and moving objects:

To copy or move an object:

1. Select one or more objects.
2. On **Edit** menu, choose **Cut** or **Copy**.
3. Position the insertion pointer where you want to place the object.
4. From **Edit** menu, select **paste**.

NB: You can easily cut by pressing **Ctrl + X** or copy by pressing **Ctrl + C** to copy and **Ctrl + V** to paste.



Wrapping text around a graphical object

One of the best ways to enhance a publications visual impact is to *wrap* text around graphical objects. Wrapping determines how text behaves around an object. For example, you can select a wrap that makes text to surround an object without displacing it as shown in Figure 4.24.

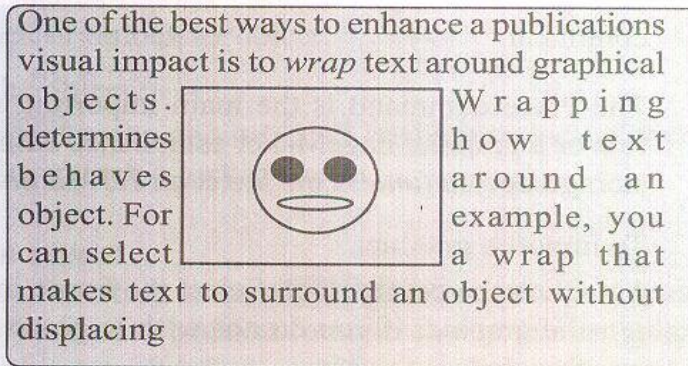


Fig. 4.24: Text wrapped around object

To wrap text around an object:

1. Select the object.
2. On **Element** menu, choose **Text Wrap**.
3. In the Text wrap dialog box (Figure 4.25), click a wrap option.
4. Specify a *Text Flow* option. The first option wraps text to the next page or column. The second wraps text above and below the object while the third option wraps text around the object as shown in Figure 4.24 above.
5. Enter *standoff* value (distance of the text from each side of the graphic) for the boundary.
7. Click **OK** and notice how the text wraps around the object.



Fig. 2.25: Text wrap dialog box

NB: Text wrap around illustrations is in this book clearly demonstrating how wrapping can be used to save space and neatly organise a publication.



Importing graphical objects

You can import a graphic or text directly from another file or application by using a process called *placing* in PageMaker. In most cases, graphic files will be created in graphical based desktop publishers or picture editing software, then imported into PageMaker. PageMaker has a very powerful object *import engine* that can be activated by the *Place* command.

The Place command is the main importing method. When you place text or a graphic, PageMaker establishes a link to the source file on the storage device (*unless the file is an HTML document*).

To import a graphic:

1. Click the **pointer tool**. Select the frame in which you want to place the graphic. If you do not wish to place it in a frame, then ignore this step.
2. On **File** menu choose **Place**.
3. Select the file you want to place, then click the **Open** button.
4. The cursor changes to become a loaded icon. Clicking any place on the paste board will place the new graphic at the clicked location.

NB: If you place using text tool, then the graphic that will be placed will be an *inline* graphic contained within the text object and will behave like text. It will become hard to format it separately as an object.

Grouping and ungrouping objects

You can group several objects in a publication especially if you want to format, resize or move them as a single entity.

To group objects:

1. Using the pointer tool, hold down the **shift** key as you click the objects to be grouped. This selects multiple objects.
2. From **Element** menu, choose **Group** or simply press **Ctrl + G** on the keyboard.
3. To select an object within the group, press **Ctrl** as you click the object.

To ungroup objects:

1. Select the Group.
2. On the **Element** menu, choose **Ungroup**.



Locking objects

You can lock individual objects in place in order to help preserve the design of your pages through all stages of production. You can change the attributes of a locked object, provided the change does not affect the object's size or position. For example, you can change a colour or fill applied to a locked object, but not its degree of rotation or its skewing angle. To lock or unlock an object:

1. Select the object.
2. On **Element** menu choose **Lock Position** to lock. Otherwise select **Unlock** to unlock a locked object.

Rotating an object

The process of rotating an object falls under a group of operations called *transformations* because rotation changes the angular placing of an object. Other transforming operations include skewing and reflecting objects. However, this book limits itself to rotating objects.

To rotate an object with the rotating tool:

1. Select the object.
2. Select the *Rotation* tool from the toolbox. The pointer changes and becomes a *Starburst*.
3. Position the *Starburst* at a fixed point or around the centre of the object.
4. Drag the starburst away from the fixed point, in the direction you want to rotate the object. To rotate at intervals of 45 degrees, press *Shift* as you drag clockwise or anticlockwise. The further you drag the starburst away from the fixed point, the more control you have.
5. When the object is in the desired position, release the mouse button.

Cropping an object

After inserting a picture or a clip art into your publication, you may want to hide unwanted parts of the graphic that you do not want printed. This process is referred to as cropping. Figure 4.26 shows a picture before and after cropping. To crop a graphic using the cropping tool:

1. Select the cropping tool, then the graphic that you want to crop to display the place holders.
2. Position the cropping tool so that the place holder shows through the centre of the tool.



3. Hold down the mouse button to turn the cropping tool into a double sided arrow, and drag inwards until only the part of the graphic you want in your publication remains. To show more of the graphic, drag away from the centre of the graphic.
4. To move the graphic within its frame, position the crop tool at the centre of the graphic and hold down the mouse button.
5. When a hand appears, drag until you see the part you want to appear in your publication, then release the mouse button.

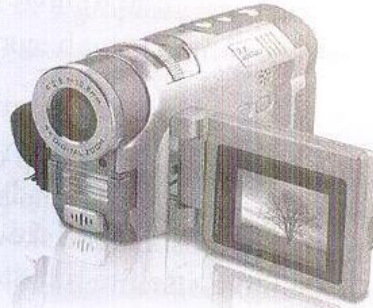
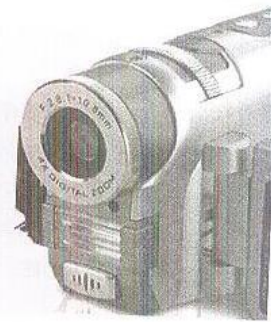


Image before cropping



After cropping and resizing

Fig. 4.26: Cropping pictures

Review questions 4.4

1. Give three methods that are used to transform an object.
2. Explain how you would rotate an object.
3. How would you lock an object in order to preserve your publication design?
4. Explain how you would import an object from another file using the Place command.
5. How would you group objects so that you can manipulate them as a unit?
6. What is text wrap? Give three ways you can wrap text on an object.
7. Define the term cropping.
8. Explain how you can rotate a triangle by 30 degrees.
9. What is object grouping?
10. Explain the concept of wrapping text around objects.

Practical activity 4.3

1. Draw the following basic shapes:
 - (a) An 8 cm square and rotate it to 45 degrees;
 - (b) Draw a triangle with rounded corners and apply fill and stroke
 - (c) A Star with 74 degrees inset and ten sides.
2. Insert a clipart from *Microsoft clipart gallery* into a publication and crop it to fit in a 2 cm × 2 cm marked area of the screen bounded by ruler guides.

4.9 Printing a publication

Unlike in other application programs discussed so far, printing in DTPs is more technical. This is because you may prefer to print a picture in separate colours referred to as colour separation. You can also show crop marks and other details required for commercial printing.

To print a Publication in PageMaker:

1. On the **File** menu, click **Print**.
2. In the **Print** dialog box, click the **Options** button.
3. Select options check boxes as shown in Figure 4.27
4. To process colour separations, click **Color** button.
5. In the **Print Color** dialog box click **Separations** to process cyan, magenta, yellow and black.

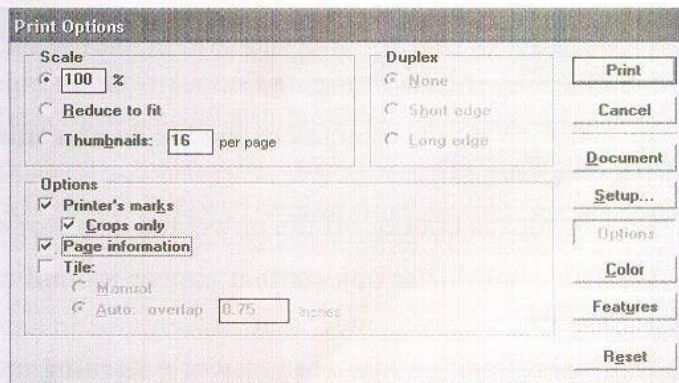


Fig. 4.27: Crop marks and page information

Practical activity 4.4

1. Print a copy of your school magazine that you have developed.
2. Using a logo provided by the teacher, measure and design it in a desktop publishing software and then print it.



Revision questions

1. Define the term artwork.
2. What is publishing? How is Desktop publishing unique compared to word processing?
3. List any four application window layout components found in a typical desktop publisher.
4. Explain the function of each of the following tools:
 - a) Pointer
 - b) Text
 - c) Rectangle tool
 - d) Rotate
5. Explain the importance of master pages.
6. Differentiate between margins and column guides.
7. How can you calibrate rulers to measure in millimeters?
8. Explain how you can draw a triangle of height 5 cm and base 6 cm.
9. Why do you need to lock margins or objects in a publication?
10. Explain the terms font style and line stroke.
11. Explain how you can import a graphic into a publication.
12. To change the page orientation to wide, click ____ then ____ and select ____ from the ____ dialog box.
13. To fill a polygon, click ____ then select ____ and ____ from the ____ dialog box.
14. Rotating means changing the ____ of an object.
15. The ____ tool is used to change the zoom settings of the application window.
16. ____ means cutting off the unwanted edges of a graphic object.
17. The small black objects that appear around a selected graphic are called ____.
18. Expert tracking means ____ while Kerning means ____.
19. How can you change the bold face and font size of selected text at once?



20. Elaborate on advantages of current methods of publishing over the traditional.

21. Briefly explain features in Adobe PageMaker that popularizes it

22. Give the difference between fill and stroke

23. Differentiate between tracking and kerning as used in desktop publishing

24. Give the difference between pasteboard and printable area in publishing

25. Briefly explain the functions of tools buttons as indicated on Adobe PageMaker toolbox.
